



PROGRESS REPORT

Gambia: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-10.

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The digital economy master plan for 2024 to 2034 is the framing instrument, with no mid-term review or costed implementation plan held. A ten-year science, technology and innovation policy for 2027-2035 was validated, after its minister conceded the previous one achieved none of its objectives (validation). It was adopted for a ten-year period and its position is unchanged (master plan). No monitoring report, budget allocation against it or delivery milestone appears anywhere in the base, and no domestic budget appropriation for the digital sector is held at any date, so a ten-year plan runs without a measurable financing line behind it. 2026-09-04 - a second policy in the same space entered the base and stopped at the same stage: a national digital government policy and roadmap was validated at a workshop convened by the communications and public service ministries, with no adoption, gazetting or published text since. The country's standing on the continental governance index moved from 28th of 54 in 2014 to 20th in the 2024 edition, at 54.7 of 100 - a composite governance measure, not a digital one.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The 2018-2028 ICT policy is still inside its stated period and has been overtaken by the 2024-2034 master plan. The eight-pillar policy statement issued in December 2017 was the foundational instrument and runs on paper to 2028. It was overtaken rather than repealed: the National Digital Economy Master Plan 2024-2034 now carries the sector's direction, leaving two instruments with overlapping periods and no published statement of which governs.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	The 2020-2024 broadband policy and strategy expired at the end of 2024 and no successor was located. The strategy behind the policy was costed action plan by action plan and targeted 5 Mbps for all, 90 per cent coverage and 85 per cent fourth-generation coverage by 2024. The policy itself is held with its capture truncated. The term has ended and no successor instrument is on the record. What is moving is procurement rather than policy: a US\$50m partnership signed in December 2025 is to lift the national backbone from 40 to 800 Gbps.	REGRESSED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A cloud strategy runs to 2027; the cloud policy that would give it a data-sovereignty rule is unsigned. The strategy issued in June 2023 finds the Tier-2 government data centre power-constrained and reliant on diesel backup, which is the condition any migration has to work around. Its companion policy sets a draft data-sovereignty and data-classification rule and has not been signed into effect. Hosting has moved anyway: the national identity data centre inaugurated at Abuko in July 2026 holds the identity system on Gambian soil.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	An interoperability framework was proposed in 2020 alongside an ICT agency; the agency exists and the framework does not. The e-government strategy for 2021-2024 proposes both a government interoperability framework and an ICT agency, and records that no interoperability layer existed as at 2020. The agency was constituted and lists powers over a government data bank, technical standards, electronic signatures and cloud services. None of those powers has produced a published framework, and the register-to-register indicator that would show one working still stands at zero.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The ministry told the United Nations in April 2026 that a national artificial intelligence policy is still in development. The national statement to the science and technology commission is the government's own dated position: the policy is in development, not adopted. The December 2025 budget speech names an artificial intelligence and emerging technology policy and a digital government roadmap among the 2026 priorities, which puts the drafting inside a stated work programme rather than leaving it as an intention.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	The only localisation rule is the unsigned cloud policy's draft data-sovereignty and classification provision. The cloud policy sets a draft data-sovereignty rule and a classification scheme for government workloads, and has not been signed. Nothing else in the base states where Gambian government or personal data must be held. Practice has run ahead of the rule: the identity data centre inaugurated at Abuko in July 2026 hosts the national identity system inside the country, which is localisation by procurement rather than by instrument.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	The national data policy has been a published draft since 2025 with no adoption, gazetting or implementing instrument. It was published by the communications ministry as a draft and has not moved (draft policy). It sits beside an enacted data-protection statute and a validated interoperability architecture, so the policy layer is the one part of the data stack that has stalled rather than the whole of it. 2025-07-03 - the data policy's validation is now dated: stakeholders endorsed the draft on 2 and 3 July 2025, aligned to the continental data policy framework. Two years on, no adoption, gazetting or implementation instrument has followed it.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	The 2024-2027 open data strategy records no registry, no legal framework and no portal, with targets set for 2026. The strategy is unusually plain about its own starting point: The Gambia has no data registry, no open-data legal framework and no portal. Its targets fall in 2026. Nothing in the base records any of the three arriving. The strategy is the instrument this indicator asks for; the portal it provides for is a separate question the ledger carries as its own row.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025 was enacted after several stalled years, with extraterritorial scope and seven lawful bases. It carries a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (review). Passage was in October 2025 (passage). No implementing regulation, commencement notice or first enforcement action under it is held, and the commission that would supervise it is not separately constituted on the record.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The 2009 Act still carries the computer-misuse and cybercrime provisions; its replacement is stuck in committee. The Information and Communications Act, assented on 29 May 2009, holds the computer-misuse, cybercrime and data-processing provisions and remains the operative instrument. The Communications Bill 2025 that would replace it went to a second reading on 3 March 2026 and was referred to committee, with concerns over surveillance oversight unresolved. The regional convention on cybersecurity was signed in December 2022 and is still unratified.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The digital identity strategy for 2023 to 2028 is in force and now carries a delivered system, with no statute governing it. The strategy was validated at a supported workshop in May 2024 and provided for a system that has since been built (validation, strategy). What the base does not hold is the legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025 for issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo; no official response, regulation or registry statement has followed (allegation).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The 2011 mobile money regulation remains the rulebook, carrying the interoperability duty the 2025 switch delivers on. The regulation made in October 2011 sets a GMD10m capital floor, a cash-merchant regime and a duty to interoperate. A separate pricing policy effective December 2013 sets cost-recovery tariffs for the settlement system, clearing house, securities settlement and the national switch. The interoperability duty took fourteen years to deliver: the instant payment switch launched in December 2025 links banks, mobile money and fintechs on a phased rollout.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	The 2019 Act gives the ICT agency the powers an exchange would need; none has been exercised in a published instrument. The agency's own statement of its functions under the 2019 Act covers a government data bank, technical standards, electronic signatures and cloud services. What is missing is any instrument made under them. The Data Protection and Privacy Bill 2024 reached assented stage on the Assembly's own tracker in July 2026, which supplies the safeguard side; the exchange side remains a proposal in the e-government strategy.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	No artificial-intelligence instrument exists and the policy is still in drafting as at April 2026. The ministry's statement to the United Nations science and technology commission puts the national policy in development. No bill, regulation or regulator guideline addressing artificial intelligence has been laid. Where the state has acted on synthetic content it has done so institutionally rather than legally: a misinformation response centre runs a fact-check hotline with a public audit trail, staffed by human analysts.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	The Communications Bill 2025 passed second reading in March 2026 and covers electronic commerce, signatures and cybercrime in one instrument. It also covers electronic communications and broadcasting, and was referred to National Assembly committees after the second reading on 2 March 2026 (second reading). The press union is pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (committee stage). No enactment date is held, and until it passes the country has no electronic transactions or electronic signature statute at all.	MOVEMENT

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Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The 2005 Act is unamended, with the African Union peer review urging a modernised law in November 2025. The Statistics Act 2005 is the constitutive statute of the statistics bureau, held here only as an image-only scan with no machine-readable text. Both reviews of the system call for its revision. The national statistical strategy found more than a third of officials unaware of the Act it says needs revising, and the African Union peer review of November 2025 urged mandate reform and a modernised statistics law. No amending bill has been laid.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The Act is in force but most public institutions have yet to appoint the information officers it requires, and requests go unanswered. Twenty-one-day statutory requests are going unanswered, on the press union's account of 7 August 2026 (union account). No government response, compliance count or enforcement action is on record, so a statute that exists is being reported as unimplemented by the constituency that uses it, and by nobody else.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The Information Commission carries both the access and the data-protection statutes, and is receiving donor support to raise awareness of them. The support is funded under a peacebuilding project to build a communication strategy raising public awareness of the two Acts (support). No budget, staffing, caseload or enforcement record for the commission is held, and awareness-raising support is not evidence of enforcement capacity. It is one body carrying two statutes, one of them enacted only in 2025.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A State Intelligence Service Bill validated in July 2026 is reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures. It would also give the National Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; it has not been tabled (validation). The text is not held and the Bill does not appear in the Assembly's bills library, so the provisions are as reported from a workshop. It is the only instrument in the base that would put a limit on state access to personal data, and it exists as an account of a draft.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The revenue authority convened the continental tax forum's master class at Banjul in July 2026. The forum's executive secretary argued there that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform, and pressed for a united African position in the United Nations tax convention negotiations (master class, proceedings). It is the country's only convening role in the base, and the argument made at it, that digitisation without governance reform does not raise revenue, is the sharpest external check on the tax-digitisation claims recorded elsewhere on this ledger. The bilateral digital-cooperation memorandum signed at Dakar on 12 June 2026 held its first steering-committee session at Banjul on 29 August 2026, settling four priorities — infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation — with rural electronic-government access named among the work (steering committee). No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four priorities, so what the committee has agreed is a list of headings.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The regional cybersecurity and data protection convention was signed in December 2022 and remains unratified. The ministry's own record of signature on 2 December 2022 states that ratification is still owed, and no instrument of ratification has been published in the four years since. Harmonisation has moved faster in operations than in law: the regulator and its Senegalese counterpart signed a memorandum in December 2025 to implement the regional roaming regulation, with caps and thirty days of free incoming calls from 1 March 2026, and the Information Commission gained full voting membership of the African data protection network in June 2026.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A regulatory cooperation and free-roaming agreement with Senegal was signed in June 2026, adding to a three-country roaming memorandum of 2025. The Senegal agreement covers telecommunications regulatory cooperation and free roaming, with no commencement date or tariff published (agreement). A roaming memorandum with Liberia and Sierra Leone signed in February 2025 is unchanged, with no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (memorandum). Two roaming instruments in eighteen months and no traffic or price figure for either is the position: the agreements are signed and their effect is unmeasured.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A three-month customs roadmap with Senegal was agreed in July 2026 to exchange customs data by interface across three border posts. The roadmap installs a shared customs system at Karang, Keur Ayib and Selety within three months, deploys transit tracking, exchanges customs data by interface once the system is live, replaces transit agents with a single administrative document and reactivates an intelligence platform (roadmap). It is the only cross-border data-sharing arrangement in the base, and no data-protection provision, retention rule or custodian is stated for the customs data it would exchange.	MOVEMENT
Standards	National interoperability standards	A national enterprise architecture was validated in May 2026 as the interoperability blueprint, and is not adopted, funded or implemented. It was validated under an international open-standards initiative (validation). A blueprint validated and not adopted is the same position the data policy is in, and both sit behind an identity system and a data centre that are already running, so the standards layer is arriving after the systems it would govern.	MOVEMENT
Standards	National quality standards	The standards bureau reports around 500 standards adopted, on a catalogue thin in information technology. The 2022 catalogue sets out the national register by classification, and the technology classes in it are thin. The bureau's director general put adoptions at around 500 standards when the international standards body's secretary general visited in July 2026, alongside membership of the African standards organisation. No count of information-technology standards specifically is published, and no national conformity-assessment output is on the record.	NO CHANGE

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Standards	Adoption of international standards	The bureau holds Correspondent, non-voting status at the international standards bodies and is the trade-barriers enquiry point. The international standards body's own member profile records the bureau as a Correspondent member without a vote at both the standards and electrotechnical organisations, and as the country's technical-barriers enquiry point under the trade agreement. That is the ceiling on formal adoption: a correspondent member can adopt standards but cannot participate in making them. In telecommunications the adoption that has happened is regional rather than international, through the roaming regulation implementation memorandum of December 2025. 2025-10 - an external scorecard set out what was missing before the 2025 statute: a twelve-area digital-trade assessment records no privacy law, no cybersecurity act and no artificial-intelligence framework, on data as at September 2024. The cut-off predates the data protection Act the ledger holds, so it reads as a dated baseline rather than a current position.	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The regulator opened eight draft instruments to public comment in April 2026 under published consultation guidelines. The consultation notice and guidelines of 2 April 2026 put eight draft regulatory instruments out for comment at once, among them enforcement regulations and a unified fee code covering every regulated sector. The practice predates the guidelines. Stakeholders validated ex-ante wholesale and retail telecom pricing tools in November 2025, a draft e-commerce policy was validated with private-sector participants in September 2025, and the national policy handbook mandates participatory, evidence-based policymaking.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Draft broadcasting and online content regulations went out for consultation in April 2026, one of seven instruments released together. The draft is made under section 226(1) of the Information and Communications Act in consultation with the regulator; its fourteen parts run from general obligations through a content complaints committee, licensing and professional standards, classification tiers, content monitoring, local content, public service broadcasting, watershed and children's programming, and enforcement (draft regulations). The information minister set out its child-protection provisions in August 2026, covering the identity of child victims, parental consent for interviews with children, and content that harms or exploits minors (provisions). Its execution block is unsigned and undated, and no consultation closing date or adoption date is published. The seven instruments include journalists registration guidelines, which is the part the press constituency is contesting.	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Tax collection rose to D25bn in 2025 from D11bn in 2022, which the finance minister attributes to digitalisation of collection. The tax-to-gross-domestic-product ratio rose from 9 per cent in 2022 to 13 per cent in 2025, stated by the minister at the Banjul master class (ratio). The authority's 2026 target is D27.5bn (target). The attribution to digitalisation rather than to rate increases is the minister's own and is an attribution, not an evaluation; no counterfactual, rate schedule or compliance analysis is published beside it. No domestic appropriation for the digital sector is held at any date.	MOVEMENT
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A US\$50m broadband partnership signed in December 2025 is the largest instrument; three smaller memoranda followed. The state incumbent's own account puts the partnership at US\$50m signed on 24 December 2025, with the backbone to rise from 40 to 800 Gbps and no completion date given. The rest are frameworks without figures: a digital public infrastructure memorandum with India signed in October 2024 with no funding or milestones; a Bahraini cybersecurity memorandum of January 2026 offering a free critical-infrastructure tier with no value or duration; and a mathematics and artificial intelligence memorandum with a regional institute signed on 10 December 2025 with no site or funding yet.	MOVEMENT
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	An 80 per cent stake in the mobile incumbent was transferred in July 2026 against a GMD 6.1bn modernisation programme. The programme covers fourth- and fifth-generation radio access, core, operations and billing systems, hybrid tower power and revenue assurance (agreement). The announced winning bid was D6.7bn and the signed commitment GMD 6.1bn, and the base does not reconcile the two (bid). Separately a US\$50m partnership was signed in January 2026 to take the national backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps, with no completion date, milestone schedule or local-currency figure published (partnership).	MOVEMENT
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The US\$50m regional digital grant is in implementation with no disbursement or results figure published in three years. It is SDR 38.1m, stated as US\$50.0m equivalent at approval in November 2023, inside a US\$293m regional operation with three neighbouring states and three continental bodies (approval, operation). A second operation, about US\$1m covering this country and Sierra Leone jointly, remains a pipeline entry with no approval, signature or first disbursement held (pipeline). A third, about US\$3m to pilot a payment system aligned to an open standard, is recorded closed with no evaluation or successor held (closed pilot).	NO CHANGE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The mobile incumbent's network modernisation is contracted at GMD 6.1bn, covering fourth- and fifth-generation radio access and core systems. The agreement was signed on 9 July 2026 alongside the equity transfer (modernisation). No subscription series, penetration rate, coverage figure or market-share statistic is published by the regulator at any date, so a contracted upgrade is the only forward-looking connectivity evidence the base holds and there is nothing to measure it against. Three operators migrated to nine-digit mobile numbers at midnight, with the fourth to follow in a second phase on the 89 prefix. No date is published for the second phase, and no subscriber or fault figure for the first.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	Internet usage	1.30m internet users, 45.9 per cent on a commercial estimate; the statistics office publishes no penetration figure at all. The October 2025 estimate puts internet users at 1.30m, 45.9 per cent of the population, against 3.19m mobile connections. It is a commercial estimate, not an official series. The official series does not answer the question: the statistics office's 2024 communication statistics publish 3.48m mobile subscribers and no internet penetration figure. A microdata release on connectivity and financial inclusion in October 2025 supplies survey-based mobile ownership and internet use, which is a different instrument again.	NO CHANGE a first estimate with no comparable earlier figure
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	D75 per gigabyte from 1 January 2026, the regulated floor price ended and data rollover introduced. The final tariff order sets mobile data at D75 per gigabyte with effect from 1 January 2026, ends the price floor and introduces rollover of unused data. The ministerial directive to lift the floor was issued on 16 October 2025 with a cost-of-service study still pending, so the price was set before the cost basis for it was established. Roaming costs move separately: caps between The Gambia and Senegal with thirty days of free incoming calls start on 1 March 2026.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A US\$50m partnership signed in January 2026 would take the backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps, on a network still carrying a 2017 concessional loan. No completion date or milestone schedule is published for the upgrade (partnership). The existing network was built under a US\$25.9m concessional loan repayable by the state operator, with a servicing history of arrears cleared in June 2020 and the loan collateralised against a minimum escrow balance accessible to the lender (loan); no statement of network condition, utilisation or debt position has followed since (loan).	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	15 Gbps through the state incumbent, with a partnership to lift the backbone from 40 to 800 Gbps. The state incumbent's own profile puts its international capacity on the ACE cable at 15 Gbps and its share of the country's cable segment at 49 per cent. The US\$50m partnership signed in December 2025 is to take the national backbone from 40 to 800 Gbps. A second submarine cable is further off: five states evaluated bids in Abuja between 29 June and 10 July 2026, and the programme coordinator flagged the deal as still unsigned later that month.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The Serekunda exchange, founded in 2013 by fourteen members, publishes no current traffic figures. The exchange's own page records its founding on 25 July 2013 by fourteen members and shows no current traffic or membership data. It is the country's only exchange point, and nothing in the base since 2013 states how much traffic it keeps local or which providers peer there.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A satellite licence remains withheld after more than a year, the minister stating the applicant needs a general satellite licence rather than the permit sought. He stated on 24 May 2026 that he had refused to approve the permit and that the applicant lacks the competencies and equipment for the terminal permit (refusal). A fee was paid and the licence left unissued for over a year, the government citing due diligence in the face of United States pressure (due diligence), and the delay has been argued in public as a transparency and trust question (public argument). The base carries a fee paid in December 2024 and a permit payment in February 2026, and whether these are the same payment is not established.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The first private data centre entered service in April 2026, on a base that had held no data centre of any kind. It was built by a domestic group with a mobile operator and a long-term foreign vendor (inauguration). With the state facility opened three months later, the country went from no data centre to two in a single quarter, and no capacity, occupancy or price figure is published for either. 2026-04-29 - the first private facility was inaugurated and announced by the State House, the operator claiming it as the country's first. No capacity, occupancy or certification figure accompanies the claim.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	A national data centre was inaugurated in July 2026 and hosts the national identity management system. It was opened alongside the identity system itself on 1 July 2026 (inauguration). No capacity, tier rating or operating cost is published, so the state's own hosting position is established by an opening ceremony and by the one system known to run in it.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The government data centre is power-constrained on diesel backup, and the utility admitted long-term load shedding in April 2026. The cloud strategy records the Tier-2 government data centre as power-constrained and reliant on diesel backup, which is the base's only direct statement about power at a Gambian digital facility. The grid behind it worsened in the window: the utility admitted a 26 MW deficit and hinted at long-term feeder shedding in April 2026, then restored two generators with a 50 MW solar contract days from signature in June. No water figure for any digital facility is published.	REGRESSED

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Energy	Grid reliability	23 MWp of solar with 8 MWh of storage entered service in February 2025, one of two parks under a combined US\$149m investment. The two parks total 48 MWp and are stated to provide new or improved electricity to 500,000 people across two countries (solar parks). The beneficiary figure is the two countries combined with no national count stated, and no source ties the generation to the digital estate. No power supply position for the national digital systems is held at any date, against two data centres opened in 2026. 2026-06 - the utility explained the year's worst outages as ageing generating units and spare parts taking six to seven months to import, with relief promised within a fortnight, and a lender's public finance review puts tariffs at an average US\$0.21 a kilowatt-hour, among the highest globally, driven by weak utility financial performance with subsidies found misdirected.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with nothing tying it to the digital estate
Energy	Rural electrification	73.7 per cent access in 2024, a 719-community switch-on in February 2026 and US\$160m approved in June. The national energy compact puts electricity access at 73.7 per cent in 2024 and targets 100 per cent by 2030. A switch-on tour covering 719 communities ran from 7 to 15 February 2026, and the World Bank approved US\$160m for electricity access in Togo and The Gambia on 24 June 2026. The Gambian share of that figure is not broken out. 2025-09 - the compact behind the universal-access target is now held: a draft national compact under a continental electrification initiative seeks US\$552m to reach 100% access by 2030. It is a draft, with no signature, financing commitment or disbursement against it.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	The government data centre is power-constrained; the accountant general says the council financial system's ledgers are current. The cloud strategy is the only assessment of government hosting the base holds, and it finds the Tier-2 facility power-constrained and dependent on diesel. On the application side the evidence is a dispute settled in the system's favour: the accountant general stated in August 2026 that the financial management system's ledgers at the Kanifing council were current, rebutting the mayor's claim that they had not been used for two years. The identity data centre inaugurated at Abuko in July 2026 is the newest government facility and no capacity or power figure is published for it.	MIXED a constrained data centre against a financial system disputed and then confirmed current
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The incident response team was trained by the ITU over two weeks in May 2026 on ticketing and threat-sharing tooling. The training mission ran from 4 to 15 May 2026 and covered incident ticketing, threat-information sharing and open-source intelligence tooling, funded under the regional digital programme. A certified two-week course in results-based management and information technology data analytics for officials opened in July 2026 under the same programme. Both are donor-funded courses rather than standing institutional capacity, and the Civil Service University that opened in March 2026 states its technology tracks as still to come.	MOVEMENT

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Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The cybersecurity strategy for 2022 to 2026 runs out at the end of this year, with no successor, mid-term review or implementation report held. Its four pillars are legal and regulatory strengthening, identification of critical information infrastructure, child online safety, and compliance with international standards and treaties, and its training and awareness uptake target was dated by 2023 (strategy). The same document is the only source for the country's incident-response arrangements, and it describes an institutional design rather than a capability: a national response team operating a cybersecurity centre with a security operations centre inside it, a coordination directorate, a commission, an advisory board, sectoral focal points, sector response teams and a police cybercrime unit. Nothing held states that any of those bodies is standing, and no incident report, budget line or annual report naming any of them exists.	NO CHANGE

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The register-to-register indicator stands at zero with one link under verification, seven years after the design roadmap. The design roadmap for the social registry was written in 2019, before a national identity system existed to link it to. The implementation report of November 2025 puts interoperability between the social registry, the education system, civil registration and health insurance at zero, with one link being verified. The enterprise architecture that would govern such links was proposed in 2020 and no framework has been published.	STALLED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The national identity card went live in July 2026; the civil register link was designed for three years earlier. The project paper of June 2023 sets out interoperability between electronic civil registration and the national identity system alongside a mass-registration drive covering 1.17m people, so the design predates the credential. The credential itself arrived in July 2026, with the President the first recipient and a national identity data centre inaugurated at Abuko hosting it on Gambian soil. The bidding for the system opened in July 2024 on a design-build-transfer basis. No system is yet recorded consuming the identity for authentication.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Health insurance is one of the four registers whose interoperability indicator stands at zero. The implementation report names health insurance among the systems the social registry is to connect to, and puts the count of working links at zero with one under verification. What has moved is surveillance capacity rather than data exchange: a workshop in December 2025 trained more than twenty staff on outbreak signal detection and reporting, and an earlier grant funded 140 desktops and civil registration devices — procurement, not systems in production.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	The education tracker carries a learner identifier for 300,000-plus pupils; its link to other registers is still zero. The education ministry has run its system on the health-platform stack since 2018, tracking more than 300,000 students against a learner identifier introduced in 2020, with text-message attendance reporting for offline schools. The country use case records what it replaced: a fragmented, paper-based system. A learner identifier is the precondition for linking education to civil registration and social protection. That link has not been made: the interoperability indicator across those registers stands at zero. 2026-07 - the first register link to be agreed is between education and health: a memorandum connects the education and health information systems to flag vulnerable children and verify enrolment. It is a memorandum rather than a live interface, and the project indicator for register interoperability still stands at zero.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	The social registry was closed out highly satisfactory in 2024 and still connects to nothing. The project that built the registry closed in June 2024 rated Highly Satisfactory, with US\$29.8m of US\$30m disbursed. Its connections were left to a successor operation, whose November 2025 report puts them at zero with one link under verification. The 2019 design roadmap had anticipated the problem: it was written before a national identity existed to link the registry to.	STALLED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The identity system went live in July 2026 on a data centre inside the country, two years after bidding opened. Bidding for the national identification documents and digital identity systems opened in July 2024 on a design-build-transfer basis and closed that August. The first card was issued in July 2026 with a national identity data centre inaugurated at Abuko, hosted on Gambian soil. No enrolment figure, uptime statement or independent assessment of the system has been published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	A national identity system went live in July 2026 and nationwide rollout of ten-year biometric cards began on 7 August at six centres. Field reporting from biometric identity enrolment centres in the Greater Banjul Area found high demand meeting daily processing caps (reporting). The base holds no enrolment total. The system issues instant cards from the national data centre, and the cards are produced with a Ghana-based supplier; no enrolment or issuance figure has been published since launch (rollout, launch). It runs under an eight-year design-build-finance-operate-transfer contract signed in January 2026, with a 70/30 revenue share, ten-year card validity, free replacement of valid cards and a second-phase data centre; no contract update is published in anything held (contract, terms). The arrangement it replaced was a foreign concession the government had resolved to end, so the country moved from a concession to a build-operate-transfer contract rather than to direct state issuance. 2026-06-29 - the identity system went live with the President as its first enrollee, under a public-private partnership between the interior ministry and the card supplier. What it replaced is documented from two sides: a lender diagnostic finding fragmented mandates, no universal coverage and weak interoperability across the identity estate, and a Kanifing processing centre shut when its electricity bill went unpaid, on a foreign-run biometric system in place since 2018.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The system was procured design-build-transfer from a foreign supplier, and now runs from a data centre in-country. The invitation to bid put the identity documents and digital identity systems out on a design-build-transfer basis, which places operation with the supplier until transfer. The data centre inaugurated at Abuko in July 2026 puts the hosting inside the country, which is the part of the arrangement the state now controls. The older credential chain it sits on is statutory: a birth certificate supports an identity card, which supports a passport carrying a D5,100 biometric fee.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A fingerprint identification system launched in May 2026 for criminal investigations; no civil authentication service is on the record. The system launched in May 2026 with European Union and international police support is for criminal investigation, not service access. No cost figure is published and the statement of its legal basis is uncited. Nothing in the base records a verification service against the national identity register for banks, telecommunications operators or government services. The credential chain still runs on document presentation rather than query.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	Registration is the entry point in law — a birth certificate supports the identity card — with no identity number issued at birth. The government's own statement of the credential chain makes the birth certificate the document that supports an identity card and then a passport. That is a paper chain, not an identifier assigned at birth. The electronic civil register has scale — more than 1.4m cumulative registrations by June 2026 — but the figure is cumulative rather than a coverage rate, and no link from a birth record to a national identity number is recorded as operating.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	Designed in 2023, the civil-register-to-identity link is still not counted as working. The health project paper of June 2023 details interoperability between electronic civil registration and the national identity system, alongside a mass registration drive covering 1.17m people. Three years on the interoperability indicator across the social, education, civil registration and health insurance registers stands at zero with one link under verification, and a Civil Registration Bill 2026 cleared first reading on 5 March 2026 with a second reading set for 12 March.	STALLED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	No system is recorded consuming the identity credential issued in July 2026; the register links stand at zero. The credential is new — first issued in July 2026 — so its absence from other systems is expected rather than a failure. What makes it material is that the connections were designed years earlier and have not been made: the health project paper specified the civil-register link in 2023, and the count of working register-to-register links remains zero as at November 2025.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A payment systems advisory committee was launched under central bank chairmanship in February 2026 for a three-year term. The bank's standing instruments are old: a mobile money regulation of 2011 carrying an interoperability duty, and a cost-recovery pricing policy effective December 2013. Governance has thickened in the window: the committee was launched on 23 February 2026 for three years, and the monetary policy committee ordered deposit reserve rules and complaint tracking for fintechs in December 2025. Both records reach the base through the switch operator or the minutes rather than a primary supervisory publication.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	A blockchain payment-distribution pilot is running with a United Nations agency, grouped with pilots in four other countries. The agency reports distribution costs cut from about 10 per cent to as little as 2 per cent across the five pilots, an aggregate figure not disaggregated for this country (pilots). No country-specific volume, beneficiary count or launch date is published, and the agency names governance, interoperability and trust as the remaining barriers before country-programme integration. 2026-01 - a transfer scheme runs on a private mobile money rail: a lender-funded rural scheme paying D6,000 per household has expanded to 16 districts and more than 15,000 households, delivered through a mobile money provider. No payment volume, delivery-cost share, grievance route or link to the social registry is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	A wallet was authorised to collect all government-service payments in March 2026, and a second platform was wired into revenue collection in July. The first collects identity card, passport and business-registration fees with diaspora payment and auto-generated receipts; no volume or fee structure is published (authorisation). A memorandum with the Accountant General wires a domestically built platform, distributed through the postal service, into government revenue collection, with no go-live date, volume, fee structure or list of connected banks published and no text of the memorandum held (memorandum). Two collection channels authorised in five months, neither with a published volume, is the position.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	The instant payment switch links banks, mobile money and fintechs, and a revenue platform is unifying government collections. The switch launched in December 2025 is the country's first real-time interoperable rail across banks, mobile money and fintechs, on a phased rollout. On the government side a revenue platform to unify payments across ministries and agencies is advancing, per the State House readout of March 2026, and the revenue authority's 2023 self-assessment had already put a tax payment interface live. Six banks are live on the regional cross-border system.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	An instant payment system launched in December 2025 across banks, mobile money, microfinance and fintechs. It is built on an open-source core and operated by the national switch; no transaction volume has been published (launch). A partnership signed in June 2025 to take public transport fares by mobile money is unchanged, with no deployment, route or volume figure published in the fourteen months since (transport fares). 2024-10 - the switch beneath the instant payment system has a participant count for the first time: live with twelve participants as at October 2024. No later participant count, transaction volume or ownership statement is held for the switch itself.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	2.9m active users against 5.4m registered accounts in February 2026; the bank's own later figures disagree. The February 2026 release puts active mobile money users at 2.9m, 53 per cent of 5.4m registered accounts — a register larger than the population, so it counts accounts rather than people. The bank then contradicted itself: its May 2026 minutes put registered fintech users at 4.6m for the same March quarter its May release gave as 5.4m, and the August 2026 release dropped the count altogether while publishing quarterly cash-in of D28.2bn against cash-out of D32.1bn. The divergence stands unresolved.	MIXED use is rising while the register itself is disputed

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Six commercial banks are live on the regional settlement system as at April 2026, with no mobile-wallet rail listed. The operator's own list names six Gambian banks live in April 2026. The rail is bank-to-bank: no Gambian mobile wallet appears on it, which is the gap that matters in a market where registered mobile money accounts exceed the population. Cross-border retail moves separately through roaming rather than payments: caps between The Gambia and Senegal start on 1 March 2026.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Draft complaints and consumer protection regulations were opened for comment in April 2026 and are not in force. The draft regulations were open for comment from 1 to 10 April 2026 and have not been made. Until they are, redress runs through the toll-free 148 line and its escalation flow, which is sectoral rather than a consolidated national channel. On the payments side the monetary policy committee ordered complaint tracking for fintechs in December 2025, which is an instruction to the supervised rather than a right for the customer.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Population register	More than 1.4m cumulative civil registrations by June 2026, a total rather than a coverage rate. The registrar general reported more than 1.4m registrations under the electronic civil registration system by June 2026. It is a cumulative count of records, not a share of the population registered, and no coverage rate is published. The legal frame is moving: a Civil Registration Bill 2026 cleared first reading on 5 March 2026. The identity credential that would sit on the register was first issued in July 2026.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Civil register	The electronic civil registration system holds about 1.17m people with a unique identification number, and its integration with the identity card has produced no milestone. A mass birth-registration and health-insurance campaign reached about 1.17m people, and the system is described as the interoperability backbone (campaign). A June 2025 commitment to integrate it with identity cards and the passport has produced no published integration milestone in the fourteen months since (commitment). That matters more now than it did: an identity system went live in July 2026 and the register that would feed it is on the same unchanged footing it held two years ago. 2026-09-04 - the marriage half of the register is documented for the first time, and it is a counter process: the registrar general publishes the civil marriage registration steps, the documents required and a fee schedule in dalasis. Nothing states whether any part of it reaches the electronic civil registration system.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register	A national digital addressing steering committee was launched in October 2025, on a policy dating from 2023. No national coverage figure or rollout milestone has been published since (committee). The only measured addressing anywhere in the base is municipal, which makes a national committee launched two years after its own policy the weaker half of the record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	A digital single-window business registration system is being finalised, with more than 350 agricultural enterprises digitally mapped. The trade minister stated on 4 August 2026 that the system is being finalised, inside a programme reaching more than 4,050 firms (registration system); no launch date is published (registration system). The mapped enterprises are a sector programme's output rather than the register's, so what exists is a mapping exercise and a system said to be near completion. 2026-09-04 - the portal itself is now held: a single-window registry on the government domain offering user accounts and sole-proprietorship registration, business licensing and trading permits.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Social protection register	The social registry holds 203,022 households across 40 of 43 districts, about 70 per cent of the population, with no coverage update since. It was built in two years and carries the national cash transfers (registry). Its coverage is cited internationally as a systems-building success (global comparison). No update has been published since 2024, so a register described as near-complete is measured at a point two years old, and its relationship to the identity system launched in 2026 is not stated anywhere.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Electoral register	212,095 supplementary registrations were announced against 179,445 records on the data given to parties, with 1,600 objections filed. The commission attributes the gap to unverified processing outputs; the discrepancy was raised by opposition parties at a stakeholder forum ahead of the December 2026 presidential election, and no reconciled figure has been published (discrepancy). The objections, on eligibility and residency, are being heard by revising court magistrates before the provisional register merges with the 2021 register; the chairman states the register will be credible once the court finishes, that the names removed were multiple registrations covered by an earlier amnesty, and that no eligible registrant has been omitted (assurance, objections). Partial digitalisation of the December polls was announced in March 2026, covering polling-station mapping, results transmission and tablets, with no procurement, test or audit arrangement published (digitalisation). 2026-09-04 - the register behind December's poll is being updated by an external contractor on its fourth Gambian biometric voter registration engagement, working on site from March to July 2026. The contractor's own announcement is the only account of it; no contract value, scope or acceptance arrangement is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Tax register	The tax administration system was re-awarded at US\$7.27m after the first supplier went bankrupt. The joint press release of October 2025 records the original award collapsing in the supplier's bankruptcy and a replacement consortium selected at US\$7.27m after negotiation. That is a two-year delay to the register's modernisation, stated by the two agencies themselves. Around it the revenue stack is running: digital tax invoicing and excise stamps are in the authority's own March 2026 inventory, and a four-party memorandum of April 2026 is to build telecom revenue assurance, with no go-live date or cost given. 2025-10-07 - the tax system moved from planned to contracted: a US\$7.27m, 24-month contract with a consortium was signed on 7 October 2025 on lender funding, and the revenue authority has since briefed manufacturers ahead of rollout and pledged fully online filing. No go-live date, module list or taxpayer-coverage figure is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The first unified national land policy mandates a digitalised land administration system and a centralised land information system. The policy for 2026 to 2035, published in August 2026, also requires digitised land registration alongside new certificates of customary ownership, backed by a costed ten-year implementation roadmap (policy). It is a policy mandate rather than a build: no supplier, budget line, custodian or start date for either system is stated, and no data-protection provision for the land record is reported despite a data-protection statute enacted the year before. 2026-09-04 - the land system has a draft and a measure of what it is for. Consultants supported by the lender are drafting the land information system, with the draft due at the end of September 2026, and the lands minister puts land disputes at 62% of court cases. What it starts from is a parliamentary finding of leases taking up to five years, no land policy behind laws dating from the 1990s, and the survey department down to two of its eight vehicles.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Health	Smart paper technology is in use for community health data capture, with no district count or record volume published. It was documented in use in December 2025 (capture). It is the only health information system in the base, and a paper-based capture method digitised at the point of scanning is a different thing from a health management information system, which the country does not appear to hold. 2026-09-04 - a disease-surveillance pilot entered the base: case-based tuberculosis surveillance on the open-source health platform covering 682 patients across 11 sites, with acceptable concordance against the paper record and gaps at rural sites. It is a peer-reviewed study rather than a programme report, and no national rollout decision, cost or timetable follows it.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Education	Individual learner tracking and school report cards are being built on a health-platform stack by the education ministry. The build was documented on a study tour in May 2026 (study tour) after the path was set out in January (approach). No coverage figure, school count or go-live date is published, so a national learner record is under construction with nothing yet measuring it. 2021 - the education information system's national scale-up is now dated: an individual-level system was piloted in 200 schools in 2020 and taken nationwide in 2021 with donor support, which places the work the base recorded as in development on a five-year-old foundation.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The registry project closed Highly Satisfactory in June 2024 with US\$29.8m disbursed; its links remain unbuilt. The completion report rates the project Highly Satisfactory with US\$29.8m of a US\$30m grant disbursed, which is a statement about delivery of the system rather than about its use. What the successor operation reports is that the connections to civil registration, education and health insurance stand at zero. A registry that cannot be cross-checked against a civil register is doing targeting on its own data.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	The police were directed to move from paper to digital records in March 2026, with no system, vendor, budget or timetable published. The direction came from the Inspector General (direction). Separately, mobile case-management applications and geographic facility mapping are in use under a donor-backed community policing programme, with no case volume published (community policing). A directive with no procurement behind it and a donor programme with no volume behind it are the whole of the justice record. 2025-03 - the courts' case management was tendered and then went quiet: a development agency tender for a feasibility study and implementation of a digital case management system for the attorney general's chambers and the justice ministry closed on 27 March 2025. No award, feasibility report or successor procurement is held eighteen months on.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A digital excise stamp is in operation and studied by five foreign revenue administrations, on a claimed 95 per cent reduction in smuggling. The claim carries no method and no independent verification, and every performance figure attached to the system is the collecting authority's own; the authority's earlier figures put excise collections at D48.47m for January to August 2024 against D6.31m in the same months of 2023 (study visits). A digital tax invoicing system with tamper-proof signatures has been in service since July 2025 and is named in the ministry's reform account, still with no separate coverage or yield figure (invoicing, reform account). An integrated tax administration system for electronic filing is named as planned, with no procurement, vendor, timetable or budget line published.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	ASYCUDA World runs customs; an upgrade to the cloud generation was discussed in October 2025 with no contract signed. The system's developers record the migration to the current version and 2021 training, financed by the African Development Bank. The revenue authority's own March 2026 inventory puts the customs stack at that system plus a single window, optical character recognition and digital excise stamps. The next step is discussed but not committed: the customs commissioner met the developers in Geneva in October 2025 about upgrading to the new cloud generation, with no contract reported.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Land	An assessment to guide a digital land platform is complete; the registry itself is still the statutory deeds office. The base's starting point is stark: the deeds registry under the 1980 Lands Act, with no land management system, no cadastre and no parcel index. Two things moved. The President launched the first National Land Policy 2026-2035 in December 2025, which provides for a digital land administration system, and his March 2026 address records an assessment completed to guide the platform build. Neither is a system in operation.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The financial management system has no statement of coverage or condition since 2020, and a staff verification round was suspended in August 2026. The system is in service across ministries with revenue and treasury interfaces; the last date attached to it is a financing operation's closing year rather than a statement about the system (financing). The provincial round of a civil servant and pensioner verification exercise, scheduled for 17 to 23 August 2026, was suspended until further notice over unspecified technical difficulties, with the Greater Banjul round confirmed to start on 20 August; the difficulties are not described and no rescheduled date is given (suspension). 2026-08-28 — the public service ministry told a ministerial interface that national identity card, passport and immigration procedures had been simplified and built into a digital services platform, which has not launched because of unresolved contractual issues over passport issuance, with rollout targeted before the end of 2026 starting with the machine-readable passport (statement). A platform complete and blocked on a contract is the same failure mode as the verification round suspended on unstated technical difficulties.	MIXED the financial management system has run unreported for years while a verification exercise was suspended mid-round

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	A council linked digital address codes to its property-rates database with tablets for collectors in June 2026. The Kanifng council's account of June 2026 links plus-code digital addresses to the property-rates database and puts tablets in the hands of rate collectors, for emergency response and collection alike. It rests on a national policy: the 2023 digital addressing policy assigns local councils custody of the digital-address databases that feed the national register. The council's financial systems were disputed and then confirmed: the accountant general stated its ledgers were current to August 2026.	MOVEMENT
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	One municipality has georeferenced 36,000 properties, feeding property-tax billing and waste management. The addressing system uses open location codes and is the only working subnational record system in the base (municipal addressing). No revenue figure, billing coverage or comparison with the pre-digital position is published, and no other local authority appears anywhere in the record.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	An earlier grant funded 140 desktops and civil registration devices; surveillance training followed in December 2025. The additional grant paper of October 2021 funds 140 desktop computers and civil registration devices — procurement rather than systems in production, and the base holds no record of what became of them. A workshop in December 2025 trained more than twenty staff on outbreak signal detection and reporting. No facility-level record system outside the capital is named in the base.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	Offline schools report attendance by text message against a learner identifier introduced in 2020. The education tracker has run since 2018 and covers more than 300,000 students, with a learner identifier introduced in 2020 and text-message attendance reporting for schools without connectivity. Designing around the absence of connectivity is what makes it reach rural schools at all. The country use case records what preceded it: a fragmented, paper-based system. No count of connected schools is published.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	More than 1.4m cumulative registrations under electronic civil registration by June 2026, with no geographic split published. The registrar general's overview puts cumulative electronic registrations above 1.4m by June 2026. Whether registration offices outside the capital are among the points of capture is not stated, and no coverage rate is given. The device side is older: an earlier health grant funded civil registration devices alongside desktops in 2021.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The regional police information programme has produced a fingerprint system, with no station rollout on record. The Gambia committed to the regional police information system in 2021, joining the shared data centre. No deployment to stations outside the capital has been reported since. The fingerprint identification system launched in May 2026 under the same programme is a central capability, not a station one. The development agency's 2025 report cites digital police case management once without naming a system.	NO CHANGE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The centre the state broadcaster called an AI centre describes itself as staffed by human analysts. The state broadcaster reported the launch as West Africa's first artificial intelligence centre to fight fake news, built by a named local firm. The centre's own page describes a fact-check hotline with a public audit trail worked by human analysts rather than an artificial intelligence system. The gap between the two accounts is the finding. Elsewhere the revenue authority's strategic plan schedules artificial intelligence piloting for 2026-27 and records it as unfunded.	NO CHANGE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	The revenue authority's 2025-2029 plan schedules artificial intelligence piloting for 2026-27 and records it as unfunded. The corporate strategic plan is the only sectoral instrument in the base naming artificial intelligence inside a management system, and it schedules the pilot for 2026-27 without funding. The authority's core systems remain the customs and tax administration platforms. No other ministry names artificial intelligence inside an operating system, and the national policy is still in drafting.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	A memorandum with a regional mathematics institute of December 2025 maps a satellite centre, with no site or funding yet. The higher education ministry signed the memorandum on 10 December 2025 setting a roadmap toward a satellite centre for advanced mathematics and artificial intelligence. No site and no funding are attached. Domestic capability is being assembled on the teaching side rather than the systems side: the national university offers six-month diplomas in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data science. No Gambian-built model or system is on the record.	MOVEMENT
AI	Control of AI abuse	A misinformation response centre runs a fact-check hotline with a public audit trail; no rule addresses synthetic media. The centre's own page describes a live hotline with a published audit trail, worked by human analysts. The state broadcaster's account of the same body calls it an artificial intelligence centre. The response elsewhere is training rather than regulation: a media workshop on AI-driven election disinformation in June 2026, and ministers of The Gambia and Guinea-Bissau pledging joint action as artificial intelligence accelerates the spread of unverified information. No instrument exists.	MOVEMENT
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A domestically built payments platform was signed into government revenue collection in July 2026, distributed through the postal service. No go-live date, volume, fee structure or list of connected banks is published, and no text of the memorandum is held (memorandum). It is the only domestically built system the base names in any sector, against an identity system produced with a foreign supplier, a data centre built with a foreign vendor and a mobile network to be modernised by a foreign investor.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A digital innovation sprint was held in July 2026 with the youth council, the ministry and a United Nations agency. No follow-on funding or incubation route is published (sprint). It is the only innovation event in the base, and a showcase without a route out of it is what the record shows. 2026 - the hub estate is listed rather than surveyed: four hubs appear in a continental directory - a disruptive lab, a technology company, a startup incubator and a co-working network, alongside a developer group chapter in the capital reporting about 992 members and running artificial-intelligence and civic-technology meetups. No membership, funding, cohort or survival figure is published for any of them.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A blockchain platform memorandum signed in January 2025 has produced no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal in nineteen months. Nothing is on record being built under it (memorandum). No startup instrument, register, fund or incubator appears anywhere in the base, so a dormant memorandum is the entire startup record.	NO CHANGE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A Civil Service University opened on 30 March 2026, nine years into a reform programme that provided for digital-literacy training. The 2018-2027 reform strategy provides for electronic government, a human resource management system and digital-literacy training for civil servants, and publishes no delivery data against any of them. The university opened in March 2026 with information technology diploma and network-certification tracks stated as coming rather than running. The nearest delivered training is donor-funded and technical: results-based management and data analytics for officials from July 2026.	MOVEMENT
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	400 women and girls were trained across four regions in eight workshops, with 40 community broadcasters and 80 peer mentors. The programme ran between September 2025 and March 2026 and is funded by international impact grants with Swedish development support (programme). The implementer names unreliable internet, high data costs and unreliable electricity as the obstacles to continued practice, which is the base's only account of what stops a trained user from staying online.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	The 2016-2030 sector policy specifies an ICT curriculum through to school-leaving examinations, with no delivery data published. The policy runs an information technology curriculum from the lower-secondary examination through to the school-leaving certificate. Ten years on, nothing in the base states how many schools teach it or how many pupils sit it. What is visible is charitable: a refurbished laboratory of 15 screen-reader-equipped computers with backup power and six months of connectivity donated to the school for the blind in October 2025, and an offer of 1,000 course places in artificial intelligence for pupils in November 2025.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	Three degrees plus diplomas in AI, cybersecurity and data science at the national university; a computer engineering college was directed in June 2026. The national university's technology school offers three bachelor's degrees and six-month diplomas in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data science, which is the widest named provision the base holds. The President directed the applied science and technology university in June 2026 to fast-track a second phase including a college of computer engineering. The accreditation authority names eleven accredited providers and rules unaccredited degrees unrecognised, which is the constraint on the rest of the market.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A national labour digital skill programme validated its methodology in December 2025 against a target of 280 certified. It is funded at US\$3.35m through the regional digital integration programme, and no completion figure has been published (validation). A target of 280 certified is small against the country's labour force, and the base holds no other skills programme, certification count or employment outcome against which to place it. 2026 - the measurement system that would say whether any of this produces jobs is itself incomplete: three years into the national employment policy the government cannot state a verified count of jobs created against a 150,000 promise, the registry provided for by the 2023 labour statute and the labour market management information system both being incomplete.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	Cabinet approved a bill to establish a national research, development and innovation council (approval). Cabinet approved a bill to establish a national research, development and innovation council (approval). The council does not yet exist. The academic side is teaching rather than research: the national university's technology school offers three bachelor's degrees and six-month diplomas in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data science, and a memorandum with a regional mathematics institute signed on 10 December 2025 maps a satellite centre with no site or funding yet. No Gambian think tank or academic department is recorded contributing a published output to digital policy.	MOVEMENT

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	The 148 line is sectoral; draft complaints regulations opened for comment in April 2026. The toll-free line and its escalation flow handle utility complaints and are not a consolidated national feedback platform. Nothing else in the base offers citizens a route into government services. The draft complaints, investigations and consumer protection regulations were out for comment from 1 to 10 April 2026 and are not in force. The fact-check centre's public audit trail is the only other published feedback channel.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	Eight draft instruments went out for public comment in April 2026 under published guidelines. The consultation notice of 2 April 2026 is the clearest single act of participation in the window: eight drafts open at once, under guidelines the regulator published alongside them. The national policy handbook mandates participatory, evidence-based policymaking as the standing rule, and validation workshops carried it in practice for telecom pricing tools in November 2025 and a draft e-commerce policy in September 2025. The Communications Bill went the other way: second reading raised unresolved surveillance-oversight concerns.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Gender equity	A 2025-2034 gender policy replaces one that expired in 2020, and a women's digital-economy project launched in October 2025. The policy succeeds an instrument that lapsed in 2020, so the country ran five years without one. The digital-specific action is a project launched in October 2025 to give women-owned small firms digital skills, e-commerce and finance access. Measurement arrived separately: a gender data dashboard for The Gambia published in April 2026, and connectivity and financial inclusion microdata released in October 2025. No sex-disaggregated internet-use figure is published by the statistics office.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	A monitoring framework for the 2021 Act was validated in February 2026, five years after enactment. The Persons with Disabilities Act 2021 enacts the rights framework and an advisory council; the printing held here leaves the commencement date blank. Oversight arrived in February 2026, when the human rights commission validated a monitoring framework for its implementation. Digital access specifically is visible only as a donation: 15 screen-reader-equipped computers to the school for the blind in October 2025. No disability-disaggregated access data is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	4,214 refugees and 552 others of concern at 31 May 2026; the 2008 Act provides for cards with no issuance count. The Refugee Act 2008 constitutes the refugee commission and provides for status determination, refugee identity cards and travel documents. The 2020-2030 migration policy names it as the operative instrument for refugees, displaced people and statelessness. The population is small and counted — 4,214 refugees and 552 others of concern at 31 May 2026 — and the base holds no figure for cards issued or for refugee enrolment in the national identity system. The state validated its second migration progress report in May 2026.	NO CHANGE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	D75 per gigabyte from January 2026 with the floor price gone, against 45.9 per cent internet use. Price moved by order: the tariff decision effective 1 January 2026 sets mobile data at D75 per gigabyte, ends the regulated floor and introduces rollover, on a ministerial directive of 16 October 2025 with the cost-of-service study still pending. Use is the constraint the price is meant to shift: 1.30m internet users, 45.9 per cent of the population against 3.19m mobile connections. Targeted programmes are small and specific — digital skills for women-owned small firms from October 2025. 2025 - the schools' side of the divide has a figure for the first time: 13.2% of schools have internet available for teaching, across a system of 830,895 learners, on the education ministry's own statistics summary. No breakdown by level, region or school type is carried here.	MOVEMENT

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	NSDS III runs 2024-2028 and its finding that the governing statute needs revision is unactioned. The strategy is in force for 2024-2028 and found more than a third of officials unaware of the Act it says needs revising. It is delivering surveys — a national food security survey across all eight local government areas was published in May 2026 — while the legal reform stays where the African Union peer review left it in November 2025: urged, not done.	NO CHANGE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The labour force survey published its fifth round in July 2026 with the first systematic comparison across three rounds. A sixth round is confirmed for later in 2026; both reports are donor-financed with international technical support, no domestic recurrent budget line for the series is established, and neither report's release date is published (fifth round, trend volume). Participation rose from 43.6 per cent in 2023 to 54.5 per cent in 2026, and unemployment fell from 7.6 per cent to 6.2 per cent, with labour underutilisation the wider measure at 23.6 and 32.1 per cent and no earlier round published for comparison (trend volume). Agriculture's share of employment is given as 17.8 per cent, which the bureau states is a definitional change under a revised international standard excluding own-use food production rather than a movement out of farming (findings).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The central bank convened producers and users of official statistics in July 2026, naming gaps, inconsistency and inaccessibility as the constraints. The convening was with the International Monetary Fund and the statistics bureau, and no framework or workplan has been published (convening). It is the first convened coordination process on the record, and the three constraints it names are the same ones that make several figures on this ledger unverifiable: the authority's own tax numbers, the commission's own registration counts and the ministry's own attributions all lack an independent series to test them against.	MOVEMENT
Open data	Use of open data	The Gambia ranked third in sub-Saharan Africa on budget transparency in the 2025 open budget survey (report). The Gambia ranked third in sub-Saharan Africa on budget transparency in the 2025 open budget survey (report). Budget transparency is not the same as open data, and the base holds no dataset count. 2026-09-04 - the ministry's own account of the data-governance programme sets the open-data and cloud work alongside the services platform, against gaps it names in the protection bill and in the infrastructure. It is a presentation rather than a portal, and the strategy's own finding of no registry, no legal framework and no portal is unretracted.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A Sentinel-based demonstrator for climate-resilient rice spanning The Gambia and twelve other states, July 2026. The starting point is a monitoring framework for a smallholder agriculture project covering rice, gardens and land cover, recorded in 2024. In July 2026 the European Space Agency and partners built an earth-observation demonstrator on Sentinel imagery for a regional climate-resilient rice programme spanning thirteen states including The Gambia. Both are externally built; no Gambian agency is recorded operating an imagery capability of its own.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	EU-funded Meteosat Third Generation stations were handed over in August 2024; an early-warning roadmap targets full coverage by 2027. The water resources department received the reception stations on 30 August 2024, EU-funded and supplied through an African Union-contracted vendor. More than eighty stakeholders endorsed an early warnings roadmap in October 2025 targeting full coverage by 2027, with a further financing proposal in preparation. No figure for warnings issued or population reached is published.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	Satellite broadband moved from a ministerial exploration in July 2024 to a licence in 2026. The foreign ministry's readout of July 2024 records talks on launching the satellite service with no memorandum, licence or launch date agreed. The licence followed in the window and is carried on the ledger as its own row. No hyperscaler engagement — cloud, data centre or platform — is on the record for The Gambia at all.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	Four data-cooperation initiatives with a Chinese province were announced at official level in August 2026; the older broadband and 5G work still carries no contract or date. On a visit to Guizhou University the country's permanent representative in Geneva announced four initiatives: the Guizhou Provincial Big Data Laboratory as a data-governance research centre for the UN science and technology commission, a national data laboratory in The Gambia replicating it, scholarships in big data and artificial-intelligence governance for the global south, and a joint summer school. None is a Gambian government instrument and no text, funding or timetable is held. The ambassador's Belt and Road account of October 2023 names broadband and fifth-generation work carried out with Chinese support and attaches no contract, value or date to any of it. The one financed instrument on the ledger is older – the broadband network loan of 2017. What is dated and countable is training: twenty-five further Gambians travelling to China in September 2026 under ministry grants, with a vocational workshop and a laboratory planned.	MOVEMENT on announcements rather than agreements
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	EUR 193m of grants programmed for 2021-2027, with digitalisation named as one clause under jobs and growth. The Commission's country page puts the programme at EUR 193m of grants for 2021-2027 and mentions digitalisation only as a clause inside the jobs and growth priority, so the digital share is not stated. Two delivered items are dated and specific: a EUR 493,346 platform tracking 237 national development plan indicators launched in April 2026 with no named maintenance plan, and the fingerprint identification system launched in May 2026 with police and European support.	MOVEMENT
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A Bahraini cybersecurity memorandum of January 2026 and Islamic Development Bank financing of the regional fibre backbone. The memorandum with the regulator offers a free critical-national-infrastructure security tier and states no value or duration, which makes it an offer of service rather than an investment. The bank's own sector page records it financing the regional fibre backbone reaching The Gambia alongside two other lenders, with no date or sum given. Neither source supplies a figure, so the scale of Gulf involvement cannot be stated.	MOVEMENT
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A digital public infrastructure memorandum signed October 2024, with no funding or milestones stated. India's own country brief records the memorandum signed in October 2024 and attaches neither funding nor milestones to it, so nothing in the base says what it is to deliver or by when. The delivery that is visible is training: the minister cited Gambian information-technology alumni among the officials trained under India's technical cooperation programme in March 2026. No Indian-built system is recorded operating in The Gambia.	MOVEMENT

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data Protection and Privacy Commission	A commencement instrument, an appointment notice, a budget line or a first annual report. The Act provides for an independent Commission; nothing held states whether it has been constituted.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country	An official response, a regulation or a registry statement covering issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	An appropriation act, budget speech or estimate showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the digital programme.	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence legislation or regulation	An artificial intelligence act or regulation, a regulator's AI guideline, or the AI provisions of the national policy once adopted.	2026-09-04

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